Referencing Quick Guide

APA

(7th Edition)

Coventry University

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Library

Journal article

In-text citation

(Quinn & Mohammed, 2016, p. 101)

Author — Year — Page

Reference list

Author — *Title of journal in italics* — (Year) — Title of the article — Page range

Quinn, D. R., & Mohammed, B. (2016). Report writing. *Academic Writing Journal*, *14*(3), 99-110. https://doi.org/10.1.2211/xnbghf71

DOI — Volume (issue number)

Checklist

- ☐ Author (Surname, Initials.)
- ☐ Year of publication in round brackets, followed by a full stop
- ☐ Title of article, followed by a full stop
- ☐ Title of journal in italics, followed by a comma
- ☐ Volume number in italics
- ☐ Issue number in brackets, followed by a comma
- ☐ Pages of the article, followed by a full stop
- ☐ If the article has a DOI, add this after the page range

If you cannot find the article's DOI and you have found the article on Locate or a Library database (e.g. ProQuest), leave this bit out. If you have found the article on another website, put the URL in place of the DOI.

Figures and tables

This section explains how to format and reference images (which are called figures in APA style) and tables.

Labels

Give each figure or table a number in bold above it. You should also include an appropriate title; this should be spaced below the figure or table number and should be in italics.

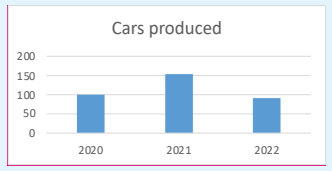
Citation

If you have copied or adapted information from another source, you must include an in-text citation underneath. To do this, follow the normal rules for in-text citations.

Example:

Figure 1

Cars produced 2020-22



From CU Automotive (2022)

*For tables, use table in the label. E.g. Table 1

*If you have adapted an image or table from a source, in your in-text citation you should include adapted from rather than from. For example: Adapted from Statista (2020)

Reference list

Include an entry in your list of references as normal.

CU Automotive. (2022). *Cars produced during 2020-2022.* https://cuautomotive.com/carproduction

Postgraduate researchers, who are publishing work, will need to provide a copyright attribution. A copyright attribution follows a different format to the guidance shown here: please see LibGuides for more information.

Book

In-text citation

(Kumar, 2015, p. 255)

Author — Year — Page

Reference list

Author — (Year) — *Title in italics*

Kumar, S. (2015). *Social care: developing excellent practice* (3rd ed.). Tiger Publications.

(Edition) — Publisher

Checklist

- ☐ Author (Surname, Initials.)
- ☐ Year of publication in round brackets, followed by a full stop
- ☐ Title in italics
- ☐ Edition, in round brackets, followed by ed. and a full stop (not required for first editions)
- ☐ Publisher, followed by a full stop
- ☐ Some books have a DOI. If you can see this, add it after the publisher. A DOI will look like this: https://doi.org/10.1002/9781118827352

You do not need to include page numbers in the reference list for books; the page numbers go in the in-text citation only.

Webpages and electronic reports

Example 1: Where there is a corporate author.

In-text citation

(Coventry University, 2017)

Author — Year

Reference list

Author — (Year) — *Title in italics*

Coventry University. (2017). *Life at CU London.* http://www.coventry.ac.uk/cuc/life-at-cul

Web address

Example 2: Where there is a named author, rather than a corporate author.

In-text citation

(Harrison, 2017)

Author — Year

Reference list

Author — (Year) — *Title in italics* — Company name

Harrison, F. (2017). *CU Scarborough a snapshot.* Coventry University. http://www.coventry.ac.uk/cuc/coventrysnapshot

Web address

Checklist

- ☐ Author (Surname, Initials. OR Company Name)
- ☐ Date of publication in round brackets, be as specific as possible. This might be a year only; a year and month; or a year, month, and day, followed by a full stop
- ☐ Title in italics, followed by a full stop
- ☐ Company name if this is not the same as the author, followed by a full stop
- ☐ Web address

If the webpage is designed to be updated regularly, include a retrieval date. For more information, consult the long guide (Publication Manual of the APA, 7th Edition).

Introduction to APA referencing

Within the Coventry University Group, most courses and subject areas use APA (7th edition) style of referencing. This very quick guide is intended to help you get started.

You must reference in your assignments. If you do not, it is considered plagiarism. You can lose marks, and may fail the assignment. You must reference when you:

- use a **direct quote** (you must also put the quote in "quotation marks")
- **paraphrase** something you have read by putting it into your own words
- **summarise** what someone else has said about a topic
- include data, images, diagrams etc. that you did not create yourself.

Accurate referencing can earn you marks, as citing the work of others shows that you are widening your understanding through reading, adds evidence to your assignment and strengthens your arguments. If you are still unsure about something after reading this guide, the library team is happy to assist with your referencing.

For more information, please see the referencing guidance available at **https://libguides.coventry.ac.uk/apa**.

Authors

One or two authors

If a source has one or two authors, you should use all of their names in both the in-text citation and list of references. For example:

(McCall & Taylor, 2014, p. 98)

McCall, J., & Taylor, J. (2014). *A guide to computers* (2nd ed.). Palgrave.

Three or more authors

If a source has three or more authors, in the in-text citation, you should use the first author's name followed by 'et al.,'. You must list all authors in the list of references. For example:

(Wilson et al., 2017, p. 103)

Wilson, J., Mohammed, S., Quinn, J., & Amos, T. (2017). *Guide to management* (3rd ed.). Palgrave.

No named authors

If you cannot find a named author, use the company or organisation's name. For example:

(Health and Care Professions Council, 2018)

Health and Care Professions Council. (2018). *Standards of proficiency.* https://www.hcpc-uk.org/standards/standards-of-proficiency/

You should consider the accuracy, quality and relevance of information you use. If you have found information from the internet, this is particularly important as anyone can produce information online.

Hints and tips

- There are good quality reference management software options available. The library team can help you make an informed decision as to which is most suitable for you.
- However you create your references, it is your responsibility to ensure that they are correctly formatted to APA 7th edition style.
- Use 'n.d.' if you cannot find a date for a source. This stands for 'no date' and looks like this:

  Hall, J. (n.d.). *Customer service.* Routledge.
- The library team is happy to assist with your referencing; please contact us for help.

Focus on referencing as accurately and consistently as possible. Please speak to the library team if you need any specific guidance.

How to reference

APA referencing has two elements to it: the in-text citation, and the list of references.

In-text citations are short references which go in the body of your assignment. They include the author's last name, or a company name, the year of publication, and the page number if relevant.

If you use the author's name in your sentence, put the date directly after the name. For example, Ward (2016) claims that a virtual learning environment can enhance your learning (p. 33).

For instance, it is argued that a virtual learning environment may also increase student collaboration (Zisu, 2017, p. 10).

Every in-text citation should have a matching entry in the list of references, and vice versa.

The list of references goes at the end of your assignment. It includes all of the additional information about a source such as the title and publisher. Your references should be in alphabetical order by author and in a single list.

In-text citations

In addition to a list of references at the end of your work, in-text citations go in the body of your work whenever you have taken information from somewhere else.

There are two acceptable ways to write an in-text citation and you will probably use both in your writing.

Parenthetical/information prominent

Include all of the information in brackets at the end of your sentence (note that the citation should go before the full stop).

For example:

Students need to develop a range of time management related skills (Smith, 2020, p. 15).

Narrative/author prominent

Include the author's name in the structure of your sentence.

The year the source was produced should be in brackets just after the author's name.

If you are citing a source with page numbers, e.g. a book, you should put the page number at the end of the quotation or paraphrase.

For example:

Smith (2020) emphasises that students need to develop a range of time management skills (p. 15).

An example of a piece of writing and list of references

The example below is taken from a written assignment. In-text citations are included throughout the paragraph, indicating when the author has used information from external sources, such as text books or websites. A list of references is provided at the end of the assignment. This lists all sources cited in the assignment in alphabetical order.

Writing at university is designed to be challenging and intellectually stimulating (Cottrell, 2019, p. 23). As a result, students may benefit from being able to book writing support. During the academic year 2019/2020 CU Coventry students engaged in over 150 appointments with academic writing staff (Quinn & Mohammed, 2020).

According to Wilson and Devi (2018) "university students look to seek help from support services following either positive or negative feedback from academic staff" (p. 100).

Reference list

Cottrell, S. (2019). *The study skills handbook* (5th ed.). Red Globe Press.

Quinn, D., & Mohammed, N. (2020). *CU Coventry academic writing summary.* Coventry University. http://www.coventry.ac.uk/cuc/academic-writing

Wilson, B., & Devi, F. (2018). Support services in higher education. *Journal of Higher Education Services, 5*(4), 90-110. https://doi.org/10.9.181.9/974975957